



Essay Writing In Word

FOR FIRST-YEAR COLLEGE STUDENTS

BY AMY FLYNN

Essay Writing in Word for First-Year College Students

By Amy Flynn

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First paperback edition December 2022

Acknowledgements

I'd like to give a multitude of thanks to Janine Solberg and our class for all the guidance, workshopping, and technical writing therapy. I'd also like to thank my freshmen students from my first-year seminar who so kindly volunteered to test this manual for me. My final piece of gratitude is directed towards my long-suffering roommates, who have been hearing me agonize over word choice and image alignment for the entirety of this semester.

I appreciate you all immensely.

Introduction

Essay Writing in Word for First-Year College Students is a freshman's guide to utilizing Microsoft Word for Mac 2022 to its fullest extent. Writing college-level essays for the first time is daunting enough without the added stress of figuring out Word software. While anyone can put words on a document, not everyone knows the ins and outs of submitting a polished final essay that will stand out to a professor.

This guide answers the questions a student could have while writing an essay from start to finish. More straightforward tasks are explained in the beginning such as double-spacing lines and setting up a document, then more complex things like formatting charts and tables, and then trickier functions like creating a custom cover page and inserting automation citations. Whatever element of an essay your professor has assigned that you don't quite understand, this guide has it all. Good luck with your essay writing endeavors!

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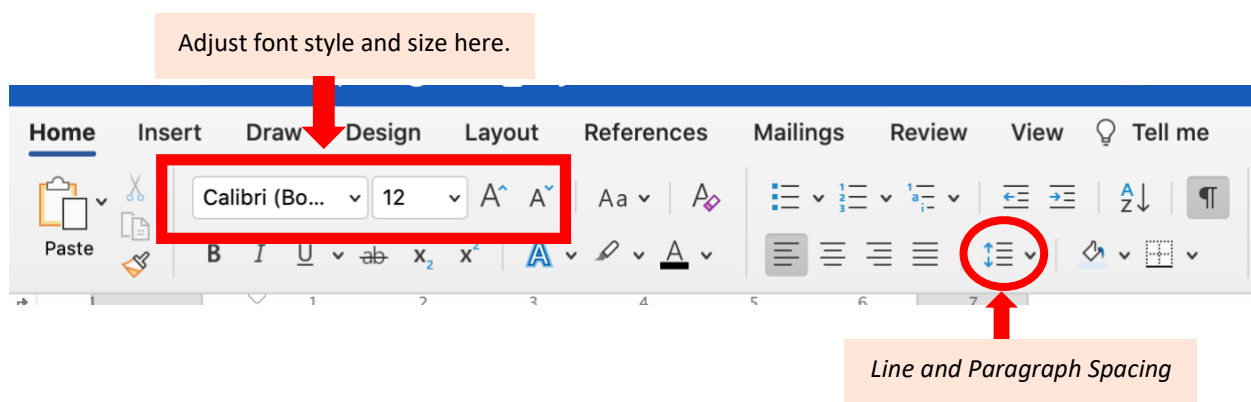
Chapter I: Setting Up Your Essay Pre-Writing

1. Adjusting the Default Word Doc

Before you even think about writing, your document has to be formatted per your class requirements. The standards in academia are typically double-spaced 12-point Times New Roman font, but every professor's preferences could be different. Regardless, you will likely have to change at least some elements of the default Word document.

Changing the default font

1. In the *Home* tab, select the arrow next to the *Font* box. A dropdown menu appears.
2. Search or select your desired font. The font stays the same from then on unless it is manually changed.
3. Click in the *Font Size* box to the right of the *Font* box.
4. Select your desired font size.



Changing the default line spacing

1. In the *Home* tab, click the *Line and Paragraph Spacing* icon. A dropdown menu appears.
2. Select *Line Spacing Options...* to open the *Paragraph* dialog box.
3. Under the *Spacing* heading, click on the *Line Spacing* box to see options.
4. Select your desired line spacing.
5. Click *OK*.



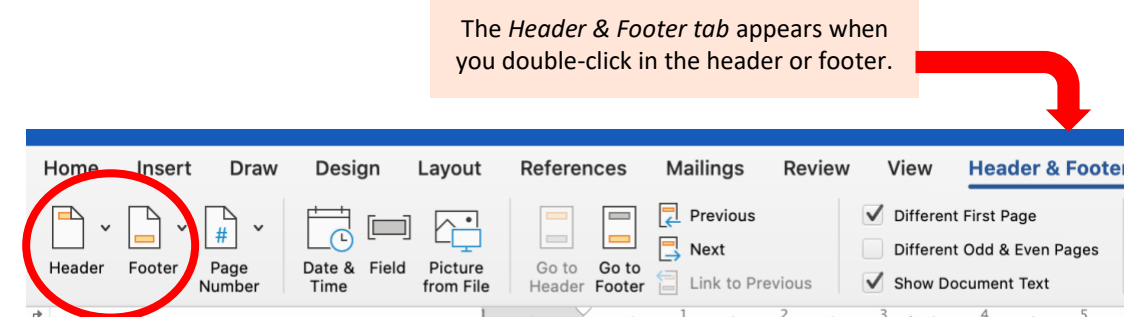
NOTE: 1.0 line spacing means single spaced and 2.0 line spacing means double spaced. Save time by selecting 1.0 or 2.0 in the Line and Paragraph Spacing Menu.

2. Inserting Headers & Footers

Headers are important to distinguish your essay from others and keep your pages organized. Professors review potentially hundreds of essays on the same topic, so they will sometimes require a running header or footer with the title of your essay or your name.

Inserting headers

1. Double-click at the very top of your document, above where your first line of normal text would be. The *Header & Footer* tab appears.
2. Click on the *Header* button to open a dropdown menu of different header options.
3. Click on your desired header style. A [Type here] prompt appears on the header.
4. Delete the [Type here] prompt and type your heading.



Inserting footers

1. Double-click at the very bottom of your document, below where your last line of normal text would be. The *Header & Footer* tab appears.
2. Click on the *Footer* button to open a dropdown menu of different footer options.
3. Click on your desired footer style. A [Type here] prompt appears on the footer.
4. Delete the [Type here] prompt and type your footer.



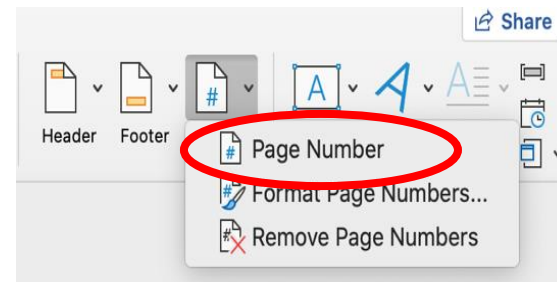
NOTE: The basic Blank header or footer option will probably be most useful for essay writing. The automatic left-alignment can be easily changed by using the text alignment buttons on the Home tab to center or right-align it.

3. Inserting Page Numbers

Page numbers are essential to organizing any document, especially essays. They are relatively straightforward when the first page of your essay document starts with 1, but they can be a bit tricky if professors require some unnumbered pages first, like a title page or a table of contents.

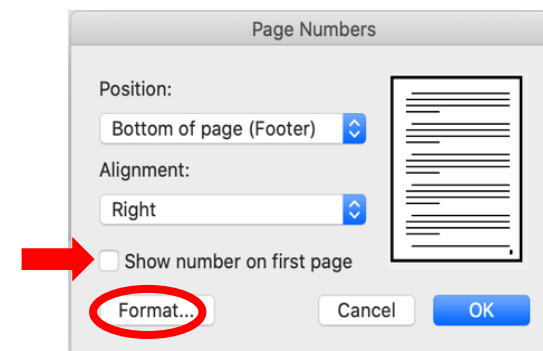
Inserting numbers from the first page of your document

1. Go to the *Insert* tab and click the *Page Number* dropdown list.
2. Select *Page Number* to open the *Page Numbers* dialog box.
3. Change the *Position* and *Alignment* dropdown boxes per your professor's preference.



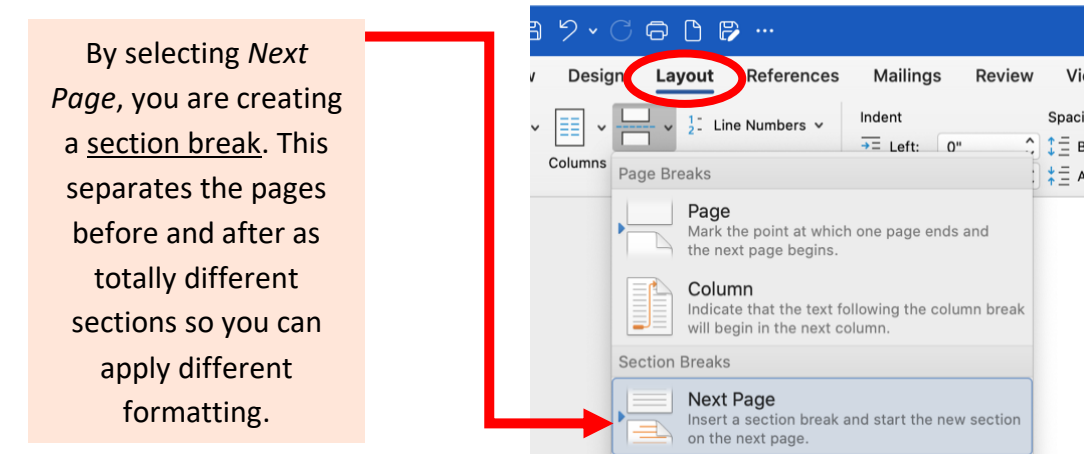
Inserting numbers after one unnumbered page

1. Follow steps 1-3 above.
2. Select *Page Number* under the *Insert* tab to open the *Page Numbers* dialog box again.
3. Deselect the *Show number on first page* option.
4. Click the *Format...* option to open the *Page Number Format* dialog box.
5. In the *Page Number Format* box, select the *Start At:* option and type "0" into the box.
6. Click *OK*.

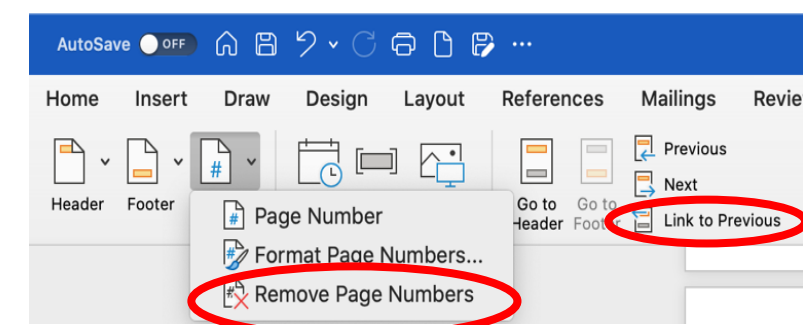


Inserting numbers after multiple unnumbered pages

1. Place your cursor at the beginning of the first line of the page you want be numbered as 1 (for example, the page directly after a cover page and a table of contents).
2. Go to the *Layout* tab and select the *Breaks* dropdown menu.
3. Select *Next Page* to section off any pages before that page.



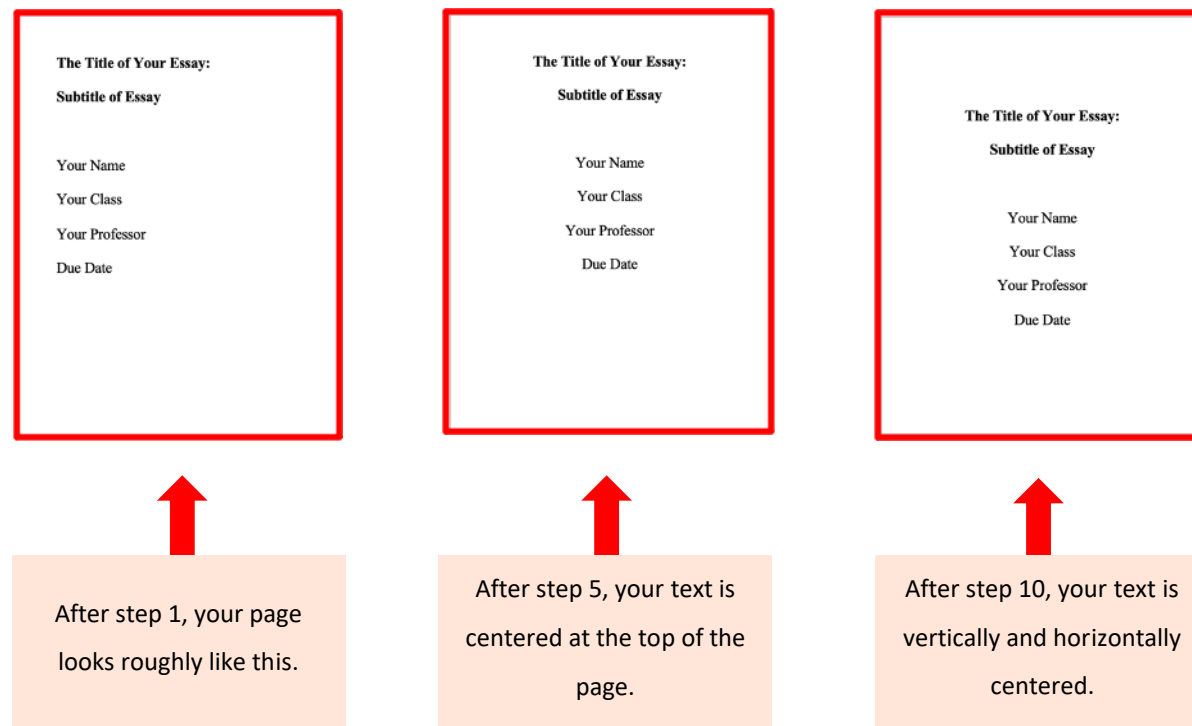
4. Go to the *Insert* tab and click the *Page Number* dropdown list.
5. Select *Page Number* to open the *Page Numbers* dialog box.
6. Change the *Position* and *Alignment* settings as needed and click *Okay*. Page numbers are now inserted from the first page of the entire document.
7. Double-click the newly inserted page number of the page you want numbered as 1.
8. In the *Header & Footer* tab, deselect the *Link to Previous* option.
9. Double-click one of the page numbers in the section you don't want numbered.
10. In the *Header & Footer* tab, select the *Page Number* dropdown menu and select *Remove Page Numbers*. Now, you have a section of unnumbered pages followed by a section of numbered pages starting with 1.



4. Creating a Custom Cover Page

Word has plenty of pre-made fancy cover page templates. However, most professors don't want special effects; rather, they are looking for a well-formatted first page with a title and whatever other basic information they've asked for.

1. Starting at the first line of the page, type the required info (for example, the title of your essay, your name, the date).
2. Keeping your cursor at the end of the text you've just written, go to the *Layout* tab.
3. Click on the *Breaks* icon. A dropdown menu of break options appears.
4. Select the *Next Page* option.
5. Select the text with your cursor and click the *Center Text* icon under the *Home* page. Now your text is centered at the top of the document.
6. In the *Layout* tab, click on the *Margins* button to open the dropdown menu.
7. Select *Custom Margins....* The *Document* dialog box opens.
8. Select *Layout* at the top of the *Document* box.
9. Under the *Page* section, change the *Vertical Alignment* box to "Center."
10. Click *OK*.



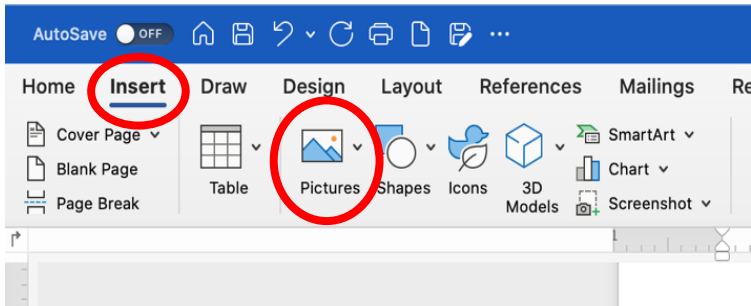
Chapter II: Inserting, Formatting, & Captioning Visual Aids

5. Inserting & Placing Images

Images are useful to emphasize different parts of your text. They can enhance the quality of your work and make your essay more visually appealing for the professor.

Inserting images

- 1. In the *Insert* tab, select *Pictures* to open the dropdown menu.
- 2. Select where you want to get your image from: your Photos app, your computer files, Stock images, or online.
- 3. Search and select the image you’d like to insert. Click *Insert*.



Changing the placement of images

- 1. Select the image to show the *Picture Format* tab and go to it.
- 2. Click *Wrap Text* to see the dropdown menu.
- 3. To change how the text on the page interacts around the image, click on the appropriate text wrapping option.

	In Line with Text: Image is placed as a part of a line; text does not wrap around it.
	Square: Text wraps around the image with a square border.
	Tight: Text wraps around the image in the exact shape of it.
	Through: Text wraps around the image and fills in white space.
	Top & Bottom: Text wraps strictly above and below the image.

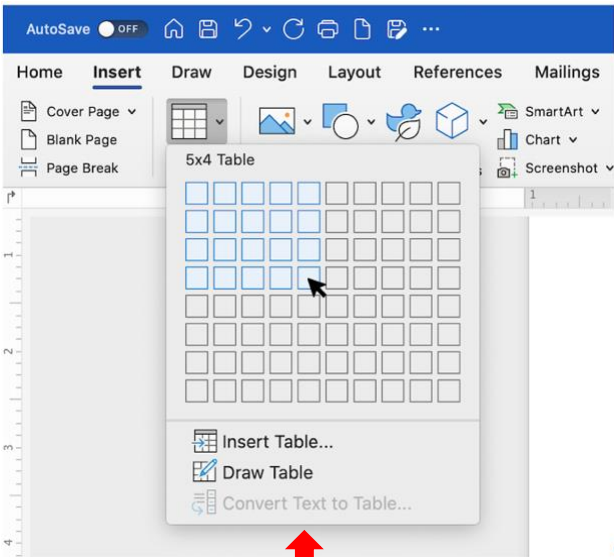
- 4. Click and drag the image to move it to your desired location on the page.

6. Inserting & Formatting Tables

Professors sometimes require tables be included in essays. They are a cohesive tool to put data or lists together in a well-formatted manner.

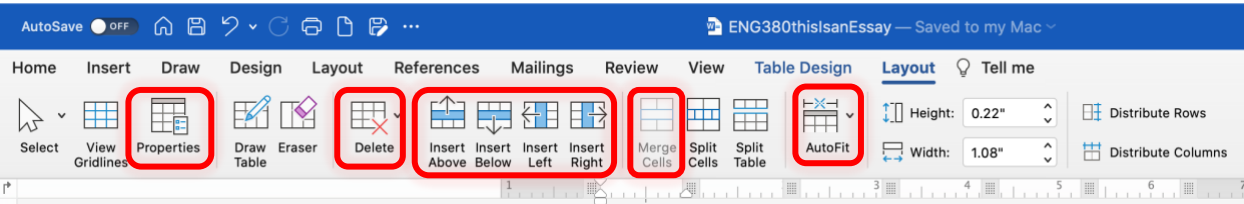
Inserting tables

- 1. In the *Insert* tab, click *Table*.
- 2. Hover and drag your mouse over the number of squares you need per the number of rows and columns needed in your table. The table automatically inserts.
- 3. Enter your data or content into the table.



This shows an example of a 5x4 table being inserted; four vertical squares and five horizontal squares are selected.

Formatting the layout of tables



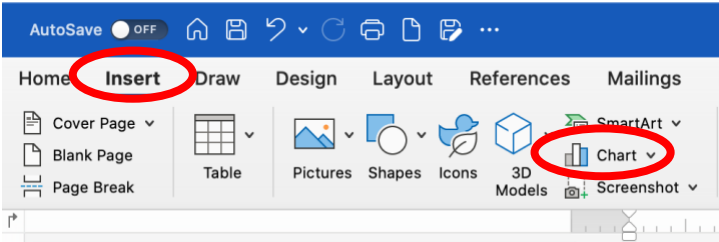
- 1. Select the table to show the table-specific *Layout* tab.
- 2. Go to the *Layout* tab, in which you can:
 - * Select *Properties* to adjust the sizes, text wrapping, and alignment of the table, row, column, or cell.
 - * Select *Merge* to merge selected cells into one body of text (like a title on the top row.)
 - * Click *Autofit* to fit text in the cells, the size of the document, or fix content width.
 - * Click *Insert Above*, *Insert Below*, *Insert Left*, and *Insert Right* to add rows or columns.
 - * Select *Delete* to remove rows, cells, or columns.

7. Inserting & Formatting Charts

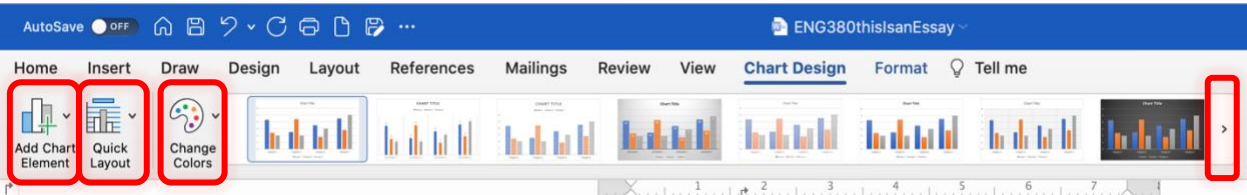
Charts are often required by professors to visually display or summarize the key data or findings of your work. They are an effective way to break up chunks of text and can be formatted to fit an aesthetic of your choice.

Inserting charts

- 1. In the *Insert* tab, select *Charts* to open the chart dropdown menu.
- 2. Click on your desired chart type and style. An Excel window with random data values opens.
- 3. Change the data in Excel to your own. The chart on your document changes accordingly.



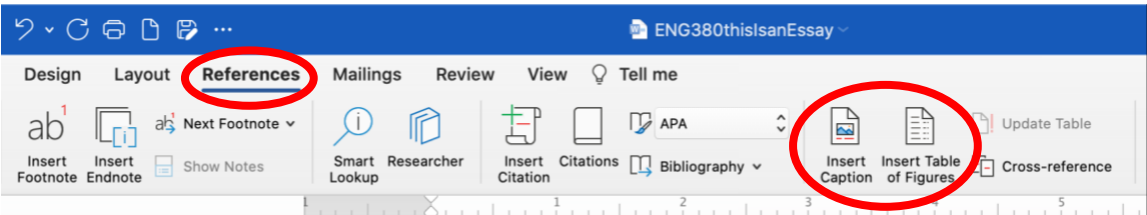
Formatting the look of charts



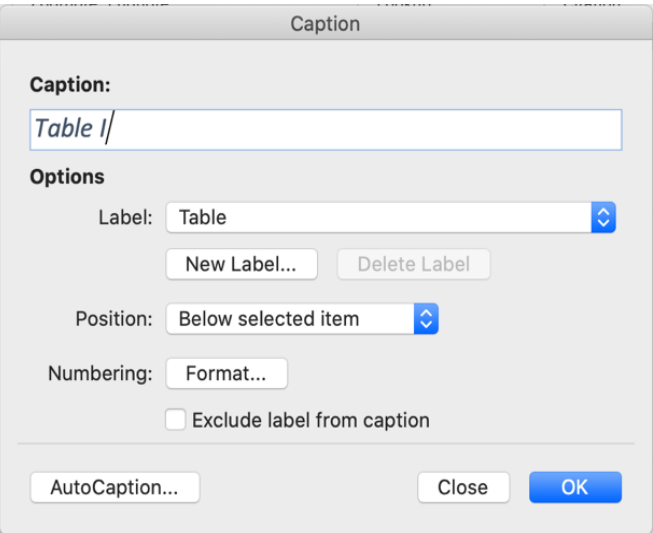
- 1. Select the chart to show the *Chart Design* tab.
- 2. Go to the *Chart Design* tab, in which you can:
 - * Select *Add Chart Element* to add, remove, or change: axes, axis titles, chart titles, data labels, data tables, error bars, gridlines, legends, and trendlines.
 - * Select *Quick Layout* to see previews and select a pre-set chart layout.
 - * Select *Change Colors* to change the pre-set color scheme of your chart.
 - * Use the arrow of the *Chart Style* pane to see and select more generic chart style options.

8. Inserting Captions

In Word, you can generate captions for the images, tables, and charts in your essay. Captions are great ways to label or describe your visual aids and make your essay look more professional.



- 1. Select the visual aid that needs a caption.
- 2. In the *References* tab, click *Insert Caption*. The *Caption* dialog box appears.
- 3. Fill in the prompts and click *OK*.
 - * Name the visual aid in the *Caption* box.
 - * Change the *Label* box to “Table,” “Figure,” or “Equation,” or create a new label with the *New Label* button.
 - * Choose if the caption appears above or below the visual aid with the *Position* box.
 - * Change the numbering style to lettering or roman numerals with the *Format* box.



These inputs create a caption named “Table I” below the table, in Roman Numeral format.

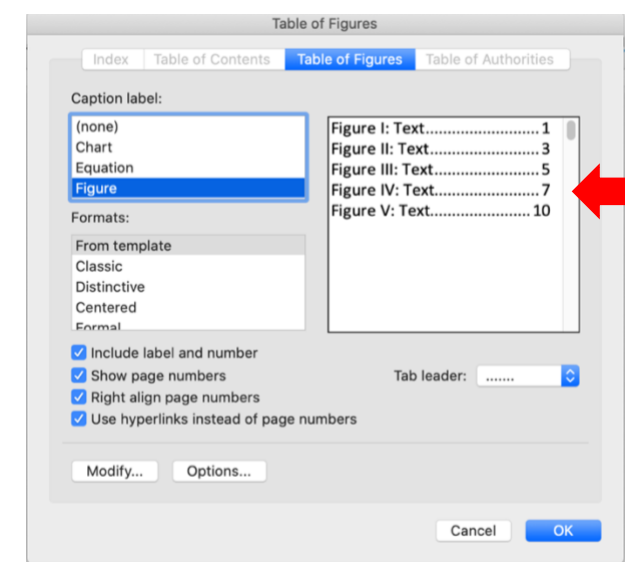
This is a Table			
Date	Sep 1	Sep 2	Sep 3
Time	10:00am	11:00am	12:00pm
Results	x	y	x

Table I

9. Inserting Tables of Figures

If all your visual aids are captioned, Word allows you to automatically generate a table of figures that organizes them in one place with page numbers. Adding a table of figures is a quick extra step that can make your essay stand out to professors.

- 1. Check that you have captioned all your visual aids.
- 2. Go to the *References* tab.
- 3. Click *Insert Table of Figures* to open the *Table of Figures* dialog box.
- 4. Adjust the formatting options to your liking.



This upper right window of the *Table of Figures* dialog box shows a preview of the settings you select to make customization easier.

- 5. Click OK. A table of figures with the type of visual aid you chose appears. *If this step does not work, double-check that you have captioned all your visual aids through Word (see page 11 for how to do this); if not, this insertion will not work.*
- 6. If you have different types of visual aids, like figures and tables, repeat steps 1-3 for each type. Your final table of figures results could look something like this:

Figure I.....	2
Figure II	3
Figure IV.....	6
Table I.....	3
Table II.....	6



NOTE: The Table of Figures is interactive; now, if you click on the label of your visual aid (for example, Figure I) you will be brought right to its place in your essay.

Chapter III:
Organizing Your
Essay & Citing
References

10. Creating a Table of Contents

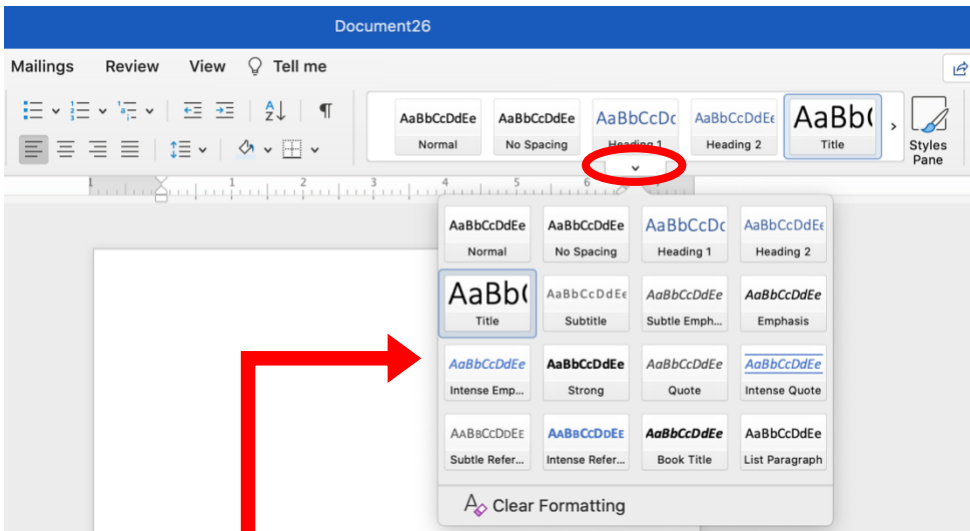
Some professors will require a table of contents to be added to essays. They are a helpful way to organize long documents and inform the reader what they are going to be reading. It is easiest to insert them at the end of your writing process once you already have written your sections.



NOTE: For Word’s automatic Table of Contents function to work, **you must first apply Styles to any headings and subheadings of your essay from the Styles menu.**

Applying Styles to section headings

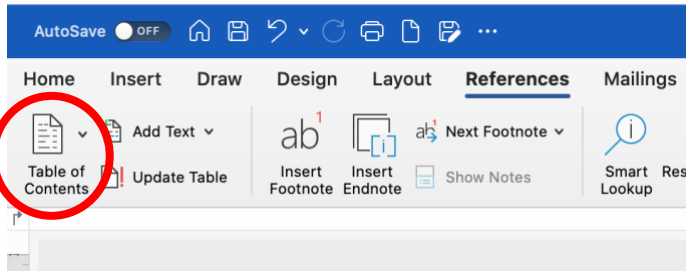
- 1. In the *Home* tab, use the dropdown arrow of the *Styles* menu to see your heading/subheading options.
- 2. Select the text you want to denote as a section heading or subheading.
- 3. Click on the desired Style for your text in the *Styles* menu. Choose between the heading and subheading Styles based on what level of heading the text you’ve selected is, not the formatting displayed in the *Styles* menu.
- 4. Repeat steps 2 and 3 for the rest of your headings and/or subheadings.



You can change the look of existing styles by double-clicking on the one you want and selecting *Modify...* to adjust the font and spacing to your liking.

Inserting the table of contents

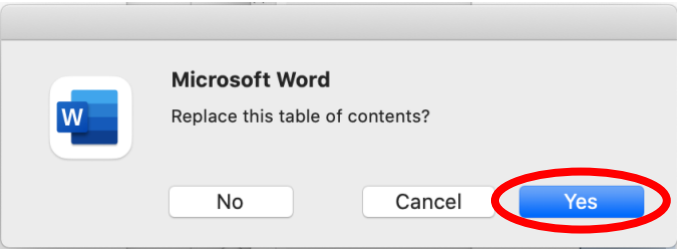
- 1. Check that you have applied Styles to all your section headings.
- 2. With your cursor before the first word of your essay, go to the *Insert* tab.
- 3. Select *Blank Page* to insert a blank page.
- 4. In the *References* tab, click on *Table of Contents* to open a dropdown menu.



- 5. Use the scroll bar on the side of dropdown menu to see different options and select your desired look. A table of contents appears at your cursor with your sections in the automatic format you chose. *If this step does not work, double-check that you applied Styles to your section headings (see page 14 for how to do this); if not, this insertion will not work.*
- 6. To update your table of contents with new content, in the *References* tab select the *Update Table* button and follow the prompts.

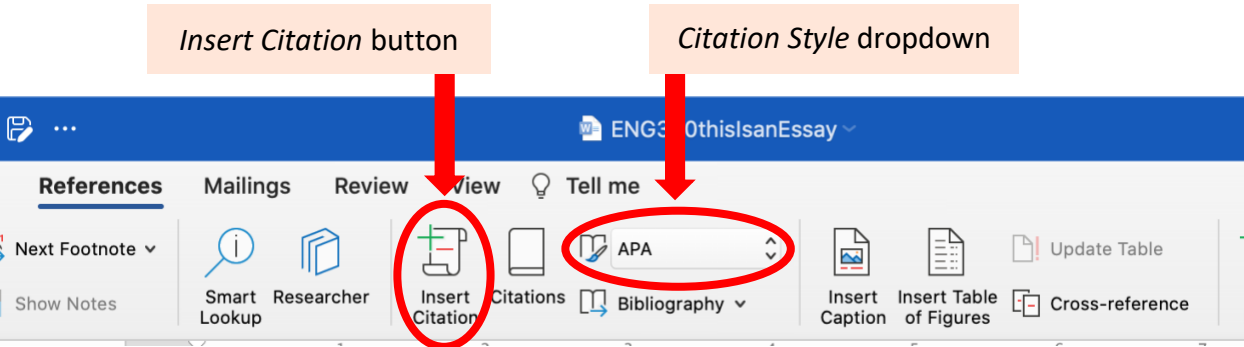
Customizing your table of contents

- 1. To adjust the specific look of your table of contents, select the entire table.
- 2. Open the *Table of Contents* dropdown menu in the *References* tab again.
- 3. Select *Custom Table of Contents...* and edit the options as you prefer.
- 4. A dialog box appears that asks, “*Replace this table of contents?*” Select *Yes*.



11. Inserting In-text Citations

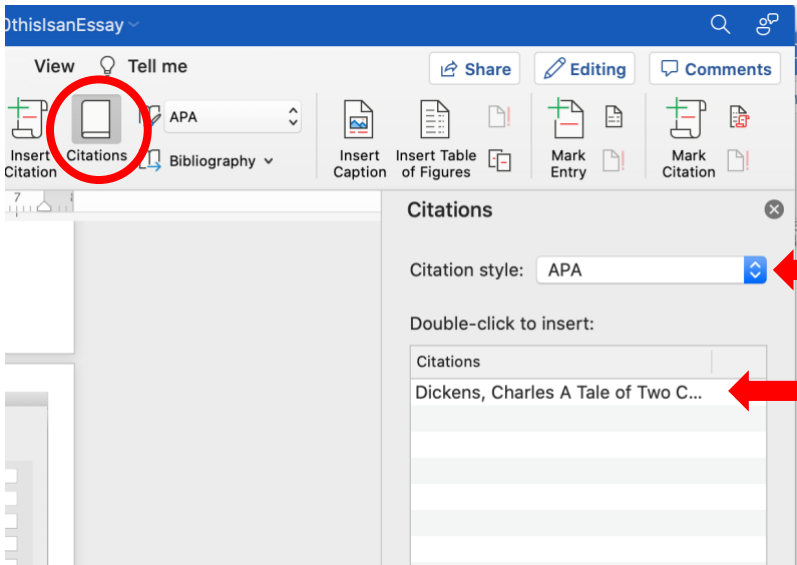
If you have all the relevant publishing information for a source you are trying to cite, Word will automatically insert citations in the style you specify. This can save you time researching the different appropriate citation styles and help you keep track of your citations.



- 1. In the *References* tab, use the *Citation Style* dropdown menu to select the one you need.
- 2. Click *Insert Citation*.
- 3. Fill in the *Create Source* dialog box that appears.
- 4. Click *OK*. The in-text citation for the source you are citing appears in the style you specified at your cursor.

Organizing your citations

- 1. Click *Citations* to display a panel of all the citations you’ve made.

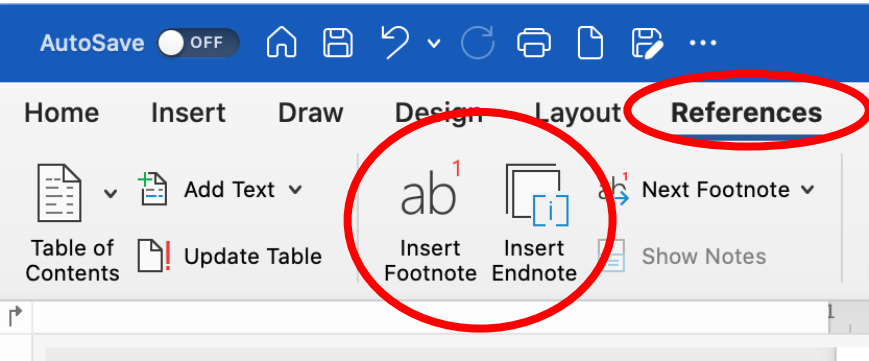


You can use the *Citation Style* box to change the style of all your citations.

You can double-click a citation to insert it at your cursor at any point in your text.

12. Inserting Footnotes & Endnotes

Footnotes and endnotes are helpful ways to briefly cite sources or clarify points in your essay. Footnotes appear in the footer of the page you are referencing, whereas endnotes appear at the very end of your essay. Not all professors will require them, but it is a useful thing to know regardless.



Inserting footnotes

- 1. Place your cursor after the text you’d like to reference in the footnote.
- 2. Under the *References* tab, select *Insert Footnote*. A number appears after the text, and your cursor automatically appears in the footer of the page next to the corresponding number.
- 3. Type the contents of your footnote in the footer.

Inserting endnotes

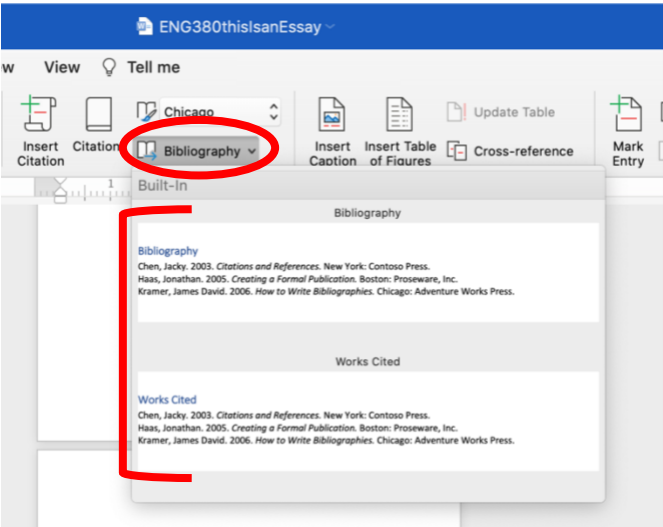
- 1. Place your cursor after the text you’d like to reference in the endnote.
- 2. Under the *References* tab, select *Insert Endnote*. A roman numeral appears after the text, and your cursor automatically appears at the very end of the document next to the corresponding numeral.
- 3. Type the contents of your endnote on this final page.

 **NOTE:** You can click the number of a footnote or endnote to be brought to the corresponding section of text in your essay for easy navigation.

13. Inserting a Bibliography or Works Cited

Organizing your references at the end of your essay in a cohesive works cited or bibliography page can be one of the most frustrating parts of writing an essay. Luckily, Word will automatically compile one for you.

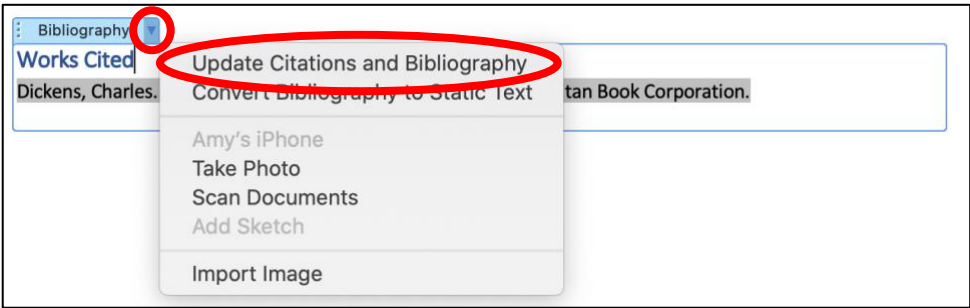
- 1. Check that you created each of your citations with Word’s automatic citation feature. See page 16, Inserting In-Text Citations, to do this prior.
- 2. At the very end of your essay, insert a blank page by selecting *Blank Page* under the *Insert* tab.
- 3. In the *Reference* tab, click *Bibliography* to open the dropdown menu.



- 4. Select *Bibliography* or *Works Cited*. One appears at your cursor. If this step does not work, double-check that your citations were originally created with Word’s automatic citation feature (see page 16 for how to do this); if not, this insertion will not work.

Editing the inserted bibliography or works cited

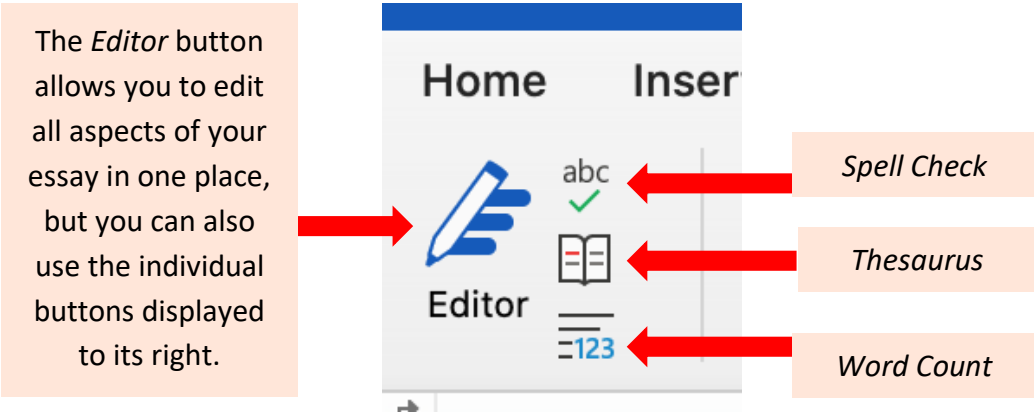
- 1. Click on the inserted works cited or bibliography. A label that says “Bibliography” and a blue line appears around all the text.
- 2. Select the arrow next the “Bibliography” label. A dropdown menu appears.
- 3. Select *Update Citations and Bibliography* to add text, edit existing text, or reformat it.



Chapter IV:
Finalizing
Your Essay

14. Editing Your Essay

One of the most important parts of the essay writing process is proofreading. This allows you to clear up simple mistakes and be more confident in your final product.



Fixing spelling and grammar

1. Under the *Review* tab, click on the *Editor* button. The *Editor* panel appears on the side.
 - * Under *Corrections*, click *Spelling* or *Grammar* to see those respective suggested revisions. Alternatively, click the *Spell Check* button to simply check spelling.
 - * Under *Refinements*, click *Clarity*, *Conciseness*, *Punctuation*, *Conventions*, or *Vocabulary* to see those respective suggest revisions.
 - * Click the *Similarity* box to check for plagiarism from other online sources.
 - * Click *Document stats* under *Insights* to get statistics regarding counts, averages, and readability.

Finding new vocabulary

1. Click and drag your cursor over a word to select it.
2. Under the *Review* tab, click the *Thesaurus* button. A side panel of suggested other words appears.

Checking your word count

1. Under the *Review* tab, click the *Word Count* button. A dialog box of document statistics appears including pages, words, paragraphs, characters, and lines.

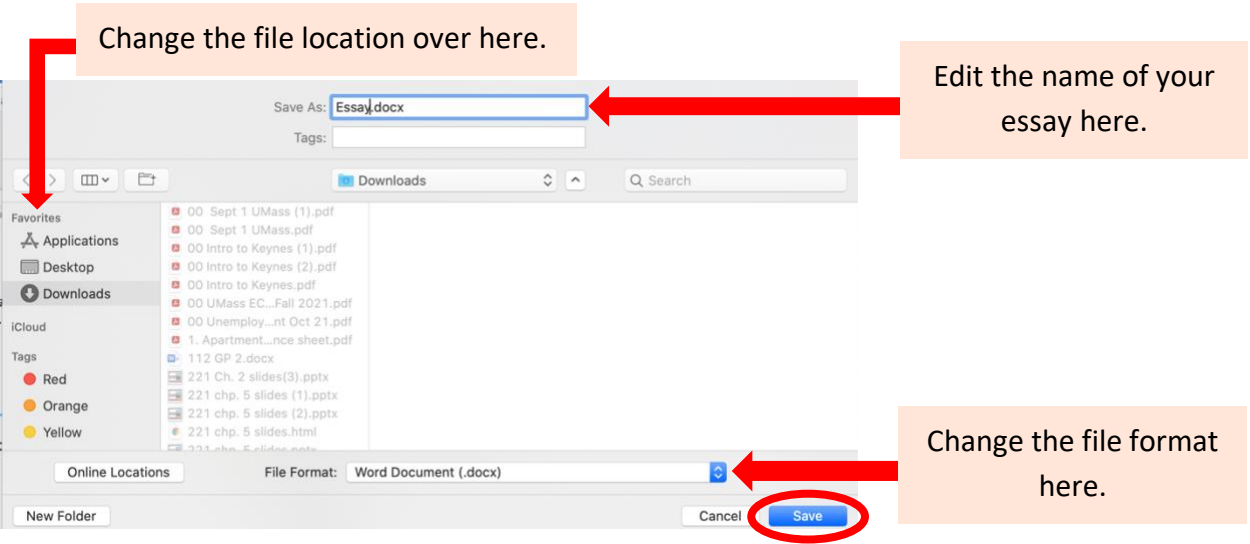
15. Turning in Your Essay

The final step after a long essay-composing process is turning it in. Some professors may require it e-mailed or submitted on an online platform, while others may require a printed final copy.



Saving your essay

1. In the blue bar at the very top of the screen, click either the *Save* or *Save As* icon.
 - * Click *Save As* to create a new location to save a document. A dialog box appears so you can choose the location, change the document name, and choose a file format.
 - * Click *Save* to save the newest version of a document. This is better used to save edits to a document.



Printing your essay

1. In the blue bar at the very top of the screen, click the *Print* icon.
2. Edit the printing options given the specific device and printer you are using.
3. Click *Print*.

**Essay Writing in Word
For First-Year College Students**

was written and designed by Amy Flynn for the fall semester of 2022 and was printed and bound by Amherst Copy & Designworks.

The font used for titles and headings is Aharoni, a Hebrew language typeface known for its use in Microsoft, and the body text is Calibri, a type created for easy screen reading. Both are known for their modern sans-serif look.

This is copy number 1 of 2.